

ELDERMOOR

Master Game Design Document — Concept Package v0.4

Original IP · Wild Arcana · Wonder with teeth

Logline: A discarded mage with broken memories binds original beasts, builds an enclave, chooses Vita or Mortis magic, and grows until the High Council declares war.

1. Pillars & Demo Law

- Beasts first (work + war)
- Your enclave (camp to private academy)
- Magic free (Vita / Mortis)
- Multiplayer native
- Nobody becomes civilizational threat

Demo Law (minute 15): Bond Ring capture · beast producing at a station · Heat foreshadow (pamphlet or Watcher).

2. Signature Mechanics

- Bond Ring capture with per-species Soften keys
- Beast labor economy with upkeep/mood
- Council Heat political loop (early teaching)
- Vita/Mortis identity rewriting systems
- Seal Echo zones (player magic weak; beasts strong)

3. Core Loop

Base manage → Prepare → Expedition → Capture/Combat → Process → Progression/Heat

4. Story Spine

Veil War seals crack over the Wild Arcana. Player is Unlisted (failed student / vessel / nobody — optional discovery). Path fork Vita vs Mortis. Heat escalates Watchers → Envoys → armies → war on High Council and Academies. Endings: annihilate, usurp, reform, unseal.

5. Slice Beasts (First Sealbreak)

B01	Glimmerpouch	Shiny bait	Scavenge
B02	Brushback Boar	Charge whiff	Lumber/haul
B03	Lantern Hare	Calm+light	Scout
B04	Cinderscale	Cool overhear	Smelt
B05	Hearthkin	Ethics fork	Craft
B06	Mirelurk Stag	Plate+cleanse	Heavy haul
B07	Bogwhisper	Silence croon	Essence
B08	Verdant Sprawler	Feed/no fire	Greenhouse
B09	Ridgespire	Pride duel	Mount
B10	Umbracourse	Night window	Night caravan
B11	Skyreel Pup	Cargo puzzle	Lift
B12	Ashcrown Whelp	Ordered plates	Magma forge

6. Capture Math (summary)

$\text{catchChance} = \text{clamp}(\text{catchBase} \times \text{methodMult} \times \text{softenQuality} \times (1 - \text{wilEffective} \times 0.65) \times \text{toolTier} \times \text{pathAffinity} \times (1 + \text{coopBonus}) \times \text{rng}, 0.02, 0.92)$. Full contract in [data/capture-math.md](#). Interactive: [tools/index.html](#)

7. Production Path

P0 One Beast Economy (gather→capture→worker→save) → Gate A playtest → [methods/path/heat](#) → Mire + co-op → Ashcrown elite. 12-week calendar in [production/](#). Data-driven content in [data/*.json](#).

8. Non-Goals

Breeding depth at announce · 100+ dex launch · megaservers · romance · gacha beasts · school sim rails · official use of third-party franchise names in marketing.

Package: [mages/](#) · Master GDD: [docs/MASTER-GDD.md](#) · Tools: [tools/index.html](#) · Narrative: [narrative/](#) · PDF export of v0.4 concept.